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LOYOLA CONTINUOUSLY REINVENTS ITSELF

"My college timings are from 8.30 a.m. to 1.30 p.m. This gives me enough time to do anything I want," says a student who works part-time to finance his studies. "Our placement cell is very active to the needs to these students; the shift system ensures that they have enough time for research as well as for the extracurricular activities," adds the principal. The beginning of the academic year will see the inter-departmental college festival, aimed at building camaraderie among students. Some of the biggest names in Tamil cinema, including Suriya and Vijay, are also proud Loyola alumni. One of the biggest achievements of Loyola in recent times has been a project based on inter-departmental research. The creation of a bridge on the Pulicat fishing lake project had the faculty and students of the history, economics, sociology and zoology departments working together. The project is funded by a Netherlands agency, Cordaid.

The course content for arts stream includes human re-

source management, medical and psychiatric social work and human rights and other subjects. The outreach programme of the college is mandatory for all its students and teaching children in the nearby slums is considered as important as conducting seminars on the growth of Indian writing in English at the college. Grants from the ugc and other funding bodies enable students in the arts stream (often ignored by research bodies) to engage as actively in research as their counterparts from the science stream.

Second-placed LSR remains committed to reinventing and critically examining its pedagogical style. "We treat the received syllabus as the bare minimum and encourage students to look beyond the textbooks—be it looking at cutting-edge literature or fresh debates in humanities," explains Principal Dr Meenakshi Gopinath. One of the distinguishing features of the college is its emphasis on research. From this year onwards, every student would have to take a module in research methodology which